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Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Government Agency Type: Foreign
Government Agency: TourScanner

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

AI Action Plan United States

March 14, 2025

From: Simone Semprini
Founder & CEO TourScanner

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

TourScanner is a small web business operating in the field of travel, more specifically tours and activities.

TourScanner was employing over 40 talents, many of which Americans, before having the business erased by the monopolistic behavior of Google.

Starting from September 2023, a series of updates made by Google with the intent to monopolize further the web, reducing the traffic to millions of web businesses, after having consumed their content to train Gemini model, without any copyright permission from us.

Today our proprietary content, together with other millions of websites, has become the basis of the intelligence of the AI models (Gemini, ChatGPT, etc.), but we, the owner of the work, have gained nothing. Not only we didn't earn anything, but our businesses have been destroyed by the behavior of Google, which gives precedence to its own AI made replies and tools.

Even if a user searches a query with our brand name appended, Google will make up a result with AI and provide that result as first choice, with most of the view space used for that result.

The lack of a law protecting human creators against the abusive use of their content has already killed the remuneration mechanism that was the basis of a healthy web ecosystem.

The web of tomorrow is a web that is not "web" anymore, it will be just an oligopoly of huge AI companies which will become the sole owner and managers of the entire world information.

Of course, considering the monopoly that Google has over the web, Google in its AI vest will become the only owner of the web.

This is a threat to the freedom of the society.

Short term, those companies (mostly Google) will see massive gains, until the moment in which the desert created by their technology will become a problem.

The AI will not have anything new to be trained on.

This is not something that will happen in the future, it has already happened.

In our company and in millions of companies worldwide, the creation and improvement of content has stopped about 12 months ago, when it appeared clear that Google was going to take over the web. After many months of economic losses, our company could not invest in new content anymore, and we stopped working on that. The same has happened to many companies.

The claim made by Chegg vs Google clarifies very well the situation in which we are.

We urge the United States administration to create a real policy to protect the creators of content, artworks, books, and intellectual properties.

If the proprietary content is used for training, a licensing scheme must exist and the use of that content must be compensated.

Those companies, mostly Google and OpenAI, went already too far in breaching copyright law without any repercussion on them, with the result of killing millions of businesses and destroy the remuneration scheme that existed before, that was driving innovation and intellectual properties creation.